

Mongolian Beef with Jasmine Rice and Broccoli

Status: Stage 1 Draft
Weekly folder: weekly-plans/2026/week-28/
Category: Beef
Source or inspiration: Next-week family menu idea
Date added: 2026-07-04

Planning Summary

- Servings: 4
- Estimated prep time: 20 minutes
- Estimated cook time: 25 minutes
- Protein: Beef
- Cuisine or flavor direction: Chinese-American takeout-inspired, savory-sweet, garlicky
- Best day to cook: Monday
- Perishability notes: Uses fresh beef and broccoli. Good early-week weeknight meal.

Equipment

- Large skillet or wok
- Medium saucepan with lid
- Mixing bowl
- Cutting board and knife
- Tongs

Ingredients

Assume nothing is on hand. Include quantities for everything used.

Quantity	Ingredient	Preferred version/type	Acceptable alternatives	Notes
1 1/2 lb	Flank steak	Thinly sliced against the grain	Sirloin or skirt steak	Main protein
1/4 cup	Arrowroot powder	Arrowroot starch	Tapioca starch	Coats beef and thickens sauce
3 tbsp	Neutral oil	Avocado or canola oil	Vegetable oil	For searing
4 cloves	Garlic	Fresh minced	1 tsp garlic powder	Sauce
1 tbsp	Fresh ginger	Grated	1 tsp ground ginger	Sauce
1/2 cup	Low-sodium soy sauce	Low-sodium	Tamari	Sauce
1/2 cup	Water	Cold water	Low-sodium beef broth	Sauce
1/3 cup	Brown sugar	Light brown sugar	Dark brown sugar	Sauce
1 tsp	Toasted sesame oil	Toasted	Regular sesame oil	Finish
1/4 tsp	Red pepper flakes	Mild	Skip for less heat	Optional
4	Green onions	Sliced	Chives	Finish

Quantity	Ingredient	Preferred version/type	Acceptable alternatives	Notes
1 1/2 lb	Broccoli	Fresh florets	Frozen broccoli florets	Side
1 tbsp	Neutral oil	Avocado or canola oil	Vegetable oil	For broccoli
1/4 tsp	Kosher salt	Kosher	Fine sea salt	Broccoli
1 1/2 cups	Jasmine rice	Dry	Long-grain white rice	Side
2 1/4 cups	Water	Cold water	Low-sodium broth	Rice
1/2 tsp	Kosher salt	Kosher	Fine sea salt	Rice

Basic Instructions

1. Start rice: rinse jasmine rice, then simmer with water and salt for 15 minutes. Rest covered 10 minutes.
2. Toss sliced beef with arrowroot until lightly coated.
3. Whisk soy sauce, water, brown sugar, sesame oil, and red pepper flakes in a bowl.
4. Stir-fry broccoli in 1 tbsp oil with salt until bright green and crisp-tender, 5 to 7 minutes. Transfer to a plate.
5. Sear beef in batches in 3 tbsp oil over medium-high heat. Let pieces brown before turning so the coating gets lightly crisp.
6. Add garlic and ginger for 30 seconds. Pour in sauce and simmer 2 to 4 minutes, until glossy and thick enough to coat the beef.
7. Serve beef and broccoli over rice. Top with green onions.

Notes

- What might need testing: Sauce sweetness. Reduce brown sugar to 1/4 cup if the family wants it less sweet.
- Possible substitutions: Chicken can be used, but cook to 165 degrees F.
- Prep-ahead ideas: Slice beef and broccoli the night before. Keep beef uncovered or loosely covered in the fridge for easier searing.
- Family preference concerns: Broccoli texture matters; keep it crisp-tender, not soft.

Review Link

Review file: